With Rideshare now installed and configured, you can begin to work with your local PostgreSQL database.

## Working With PostgreSQL Locally

If you're an experienced PostgreSQL user you may wish to skip this section.

In the exercises here you'll work exclusively using your local version of PostgreSQL running the open source community distribution. You'll get some repetition in by regularly developing and testing in your local database. Your local PostgreSQL database will have less functionality compared with modern cloud hosted PostgreSQL instances, but it will be less complex and you'll have full control over it. You'll use your local instance to develop skills you can take with you into your production instance.

You'll view log files, modify parameters, and start and stop your server instance. Since you're working locally on PostgreSQL, any queries or processes are in your control and you may restart it at will. In production a database restart requires careful planning and is generally avoided. Thus, you'll practice "reloading" configuration changes where possible to avoid restarts.

PostgreSQL is an extensible database. Here you'll be limited to open source PostgreSQL only, and you'll work with extensions from the PostgreSQL "ecosystem". Extensions expand the core functionality. The extensions featured here have broad support from the major PostgreSQL cloud providers. If you're self-hosting PostgreSQL you can of course install and configure any extensions that you wish.

With that in mind, let's jump into some PostgreSQL terminology.

## Learning PostgreSQL Terminology

PostgreSQL is an object relational database. If you're a programmer and are familiar with Object Oriented Programming (OOP) then you might think of objects like Ruby classes and inheritance hierarchies.

In PostgreSQL, database objects are things like tables, indexes, schemas, column defaults, or constraints. Objects in Ruby and objects in PostgreSQL refer to different things.

Databases have a LOT of terminology to familiarize yourself with. Newer database users may benefit from a terminology glossary to begin to digest some of the database specific terminology. Early and frequent exposure to terms is important, so there are terminology guides in most chapters that provide a short, simple definition for each term.